

India's Proposed BRICS Reform Roadmap



For Prelims: United Nations Secretary-General , UN Security Council , Bretton Woods institutions , Artificial Intelligence , Critical minerals , G7 , SWIFT messaging system

For Mains: Reform of Global Governance Institutions, Crisis of Multilateralism, India's Role in Reformed Multilateralism

Source: TH

Why in News?

During the **18 th BRICS Summit** held in New Delhi (September 2026), the Indian Prime Minister urged BRICS leaders to formulate **10 global governance reform proposals** . These proposals are intended to be developed into a comprehensive **BRICS Reform Roadmap** by the next summit in 2027.

- Concurrently, the **United Nations Secretary-General** highlighted that "**distorted power relations in the world make the Security Council non-operational**," reaffirming the urgent need to address the democratic deficit in global multilateral institutions.

Summary

- India's proposed BRICS Reform Roadmap** seeks to reform global institutions through **Representation, Responsiveness and inclusive rule-making** , giving the Global South a greater role in decision-making.
- It aims to address challenges such as **UNSC underrepresentation, financial governance imbalances, WTO paralysis and exclusion from emerging-technology rule-making** , making global governance more inclusive and equitable.

What are the Key Highlights of India's Proposed BRICS Reform Roadmap?

- **From "Rule-Takers to Rule-Shapers":** India emphasized the need to dismantle the current global governance structure (described as a **"pyramid of privilege"**) and transform it into a **"platform of partnership."**
 - This is crucial as the **Global South** is at the forefront of global crises but remains excluded from key decision-making.
- **Consensus-Based Approach:** India highlighted that BRICS seeks to advance global reforms through dialogue, consensus and cooperation, not as a counter-bloc against any country.
- **The Three Pillars (The 3Rs):** The 10 proposed reform measures will focus on three broad areas — Representation, Responsiveness and Rule-making.
 - **Representation:** The reform of the **UN Security Council (UNSC)** can no longer be delayed. Text-based negotiations for expanding the UNSC must be linked to a definite timeline and clear outcomes.
 - Furthermore, the voting power and leadership roles in **Bretton Woods institutions (IMF, World Bank)** must reflect contemporary economic realities, granting proportional influence to emerging engines of global growth.
 - **Responsiveness:** Global institutions must improve the speed, scale, and last-mile impact of their crisis responses.
 - As a practical example, India proposed establishing a **Seafarers' Emergency Support Network** to connect maritime authorities and missions, ensuring rapid distress alerts, medical aid, and evacuation for maritime workers.
- **Rule-Making in Emerging Technologies:** Equal participation is vital in framing global regulations for future domains such as **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** , **cyberspace, outer space, biotechnology, and critical minerals** .
 - To achieve this, BRICS aims to provide young diplomats from the Global South with legal, practical, and negotiation expertise to actively shape these future rules.
- **BRICS Continuity and Implementation Mechanism:** To prevent institutional momentum from stalling due to annual Presidency rotations, India proposed creating a formal mechanism utilizing the **BRICS Troika (current, previous, and incoming chairs)** and a secure digital repository to systematically track initiatives, deadlines, and implementation statuses.

Significance

- **Empowering the Global South:** By proposing a concrete, 10-point roadmap, India leverages the expanded 11-member BRICS grouping (**representing ~40% of global GDP and nearly half the world's population**) as a collective counterweight to Western-dominated forums like the **G7**.
 - It ensures the Global South's demographic and economic weight translates into actual global policy impact.
- **Future-Proofing Governance:** By expanding the scope of reform beyond traditional bodies (like the UN) to frontier technologies (AI, cyberspace), the roadmap ensures that developing nations are not locked out of the regulatory frameworks that will define the 21st-century global economy.
- **Transitioning from Critique to Constructive Action:** As BRICS celebrates its 20th anniversary, this roadmap signifies the bloc's **"coming of age"**.
 - It shifts the grouping's focus from merely critiquing the outdated Western institutional architecture to **actively providing constructive, structured, and alternative frameworks** for equitable global governance.

What are the Impediments to Global Governance

Institutions?

- **Outdated Representation in the UNSC:** The UNSC largely reflects the geopolitical realities of the **post-World War II era** . The absolute exclusion of entire continents impacts the body's global legitimacy.
 - For instance, Africa and Latin America have zero permanent representation. This has prompted coalitions like the **G4 nations (India, Brazil, Germany, Japan)** to strongly advocate for permanent seats, while the **Sirte Declaration and Ezulwini Consensus** outline the unified African demand for two permanent seats to reflect contemporary demographics.
- **Conventions in Global Finance:** The Bretton Woods Institutions operate on an unwritten agreement reserving the **World Bank Presidency for an American** and the **IMF leadership for a European** . Existing quota formulas fail to reflect the economic weight of emerging economies like India, skewing global financial decision-making.
- **Constraints of the Veto Power:** The frequent use of veto power by the **Permanent Five (P5)** to shield strategic allies has paralyzed the UNSC. Repeated vetoes by **Russia regarding Ukraine** and the **US regarding Gaza** highlight its inability to maintain international peace.
- **Inconsistencies in the Application of Norms:** Multilateralism suffers from a trust deficit due to the selective application of international law, visible in the unequal enforcement of frameworks like the **Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT)** based on geopolitical alliances rather than universal rules.
- **Over-reliance on Earmarked Funding:** A shift toward conditional, voluntary contributions from wealthy donor nations and philanthropies forces UN bodies to prioritize donor interests over universal mandates. Currently, over **80% of the WHO's budget** relies on such earmarked funding.
- **Challenges in the WTO Dispute Mechanism:** The **World Trade Organization's** dispute settlement mechanism remains crippled because the **US has systematically blocked appointments to the Appellate Body** since 2019, allowing nations to violate trade rules without facing enforcement.
- **Unilateral Trade and Environmental Measures:** Developed nations increasingly bypass multilateral consensus through unilateral measures like the **EU's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM)** or trade-distorting domestic subsidies like the **US Inflation Reduction Act (IRA)** , which disproportionately burden developing economies.
- **Instrumentalization of Financial Systems:** The geopolitical weaponization of global financial infrastructure such as expulsions from the **SWIFT messaging system** and the freezing of sovereign central bank reserves erodes trust in its neutrality and accelerates de-dollarization efforts among BRICS nations.
- **Rise of "Minilateralism" and Fragmented Tech Governance:** Rule-making for emerging domains is increasingly monopolized by exclusive Western coalitions like the **G7 Hiroshima AI Process** , locking the Global South out of global technological governance.
- **Differing Regional Perspectives:** Reform efforts are often stalled by internal fragmentation among developing nations. Coalitions like the **"Uniting for Consensus" (Coffee Club)** actively oppose the creation of new permanent UNSC seats to block regional rivals (e.g., Pakistan opposing India's bid).
- **Policy Volatility & Multilateral Disengagement:** **US withdrawal from the Paris Agreement** weakens global climate leadership, disrupts climate finance through mechanisms like the **Green Climate Fund and Loss and Damage Fund (LDF)** , and discourages countries from adhering to their **Nationally Determined Contributions** .
- **Funding Boycotts:** Geopolitical disputes, including **US and Israeli withdrawals from UNESCO** , have reduced funding, weakened its operations, and undermined its work in **education, science, and cultural preservation** .

Way Forward

- **Transitioning to Text-Based Negotiations:** The UN General Assembly must move beyond open-ended debates within the Intergovernmental Negotiations (IGN) framework and commit to **time-bound, text-based negotiations to formalize the expansion of the UNSC** in both permanent and non-permanent categories.
- **Democratizing the Financial Architecture:** There is an urgent need to expedite **quota realignments at the IMF and World Bank** to accurately reflect the current GDP and purchasing power of emerging economies.
 - Additionally, leadership appointments must transition to a transparent, merit-based system, discarding outdated geographical monopolies.
- **Restoring the Multilateral Trade Order:** The international community must prioritize the revival of the **WTO's two-tier dispute settlement mechanism by breaking the deadlock on Appellate Body appointments**, while actively safeguarding **Special and Differential Treatment (S&DT)** provisions for developing nations.
- **Forging a Unified Global South Consensus:** To overcome internal fragmentation platforms like **BRICS, the African Union, and the G20** must build diplomatic bridges to present a cohesive, unified front on institutional reforms, climate justice, and equitable trade.
- **Proactive Norm-Setting in Frontier Technologies:** The Global South must operationalize the **BRICS tech-diplomacy initiatives to co-create universal**, UN-backed regulatory frameworks for AI, outer space, and critical minerals. This will ensure developing nations transition from passive consumers to active architects of future global norms.

Conclusion

The **BRICS Reform Roadmap** seeks to make global governance more **representative, inclusive and equitable** by enabling the Global South to move from **“rule-takers” to “rule-shapers”** and transform the existing **“pyramid of privilege” into a “platform of partnership.”**

Drishti Mains Question:

“Representation without responsiveness cannot ensure legitimacy of global institutions.” Discuss in the context of India’s proposed 3Rs framework.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What are the three pillars of India's proposed BRICS Reform Roadmap?

The three pillars are **Representation, Responsiveness and Rule-Making in Emerging Technologies**, aimed at giving the Global South greater influence in global governance.

2. Why is UNSC reform important for the Global South?

The UNSC reflects the **post-World War II power structure**, with inadequate representation of Africa, Latin America and other developing regions.

3. What is the significance of the Ezulwini Consensus?

The **Ezulwini Consensus** represents Africa's common position seeking **two permanent and additional non-permanent seats** on a reformed UNSC.

4. What are the major challenges to global governance reform?

Key challenges include **veto power, outdated representation, geopolitical rivalries, institutional fragmentation, selective application of norms and divisions among developing countries**.

5. How can the Global South become "rule-shapers"?

Developing countries can strengthen **collective diplomacy through BRICS, G20 and the African Union**, while actively participating in rule-making on finance, trade, climate and emerging technologies.

[Watch Video on YouTube: [▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/JqHhJWrDogI](https://www.youtube.com/embed/JqHhJWrDogI)]

UPSC Civil Services Examination Previous Year Question (PYQ) *Prelims*

Q. With reference to the "United Nations Credentials Committee", consider the following statements: (2022)

1. It is a committee set up by the UN Security Council and works under its supervision.
2. It traditionally meets in March, June and September every year
3. It assesses the credentials of all UN members before submitting a report to the General Assembly for approval.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 3 only
- (b) 1 and 3
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 1 and 2

Ans: (a)

Mains

Q. The reform process in the United Nations remains unresolved because of the delicate imbalance of East and West and entanglement of the USA vs. Russo-Chinese alliance. Examine and critically evaluate the East-West policy confrontations in this regard. **(2025).**

China's Open-Source AI Strategy



Source: IE

Why in News?

At the **BRICS Summit in New Delhi (September 2026)**, China proposed establishing a **BRICS open-source AI community** , presenting a strategic dilemma for India's digital autonomy.

What is China's 'Open-Source' AI Strategy?

- **The BRICS Proposal:** At the 18 th BRICS Summit, China offered to lead the creation of a BRICS open-source AI community, complete with shared **large language models (LLMs)** and a digital ecosystem cloud platform.
- **Bypassing US Sanctions:** While the US dominates advanced AI chip manufacturing and proprietary closed-source models (like OpenAI's GPT-4).
 - Heavily restricted by **US semiconductor export bans** , China cannot dominate hardware. Instead, it aims to dominate the software layer. By making the **Global South dependent on Chinese open-source AI architecture, Beijing ensures long-term technological relevance.**
- **The Strategy:** Chinese tech giants (like **Alibaba with its Qwen model**) are releasing highly capable, open-source AI foundational models for free.
 - Developers worldwide can download, modify, and build applications upon these Chinese architectures.
- **The 'Android' Playbook:** By distributing advanced models (such as **DeepSeek** and Alibaba's Qwen) freely as open weights, China seeks to replicate Google's Android strategy.
 - This establishes Chinese software architectures as the default digital infrastructure for emerging economies that cannot afford expensive proprietary Western licenses.

Implications for India

- **Strategic Autonomy Dilemma:** India advocates a **"third way" in global AI governance** based on strategic autonomy, democratic values and privacy-preserving infrastructure.
 - However, joining a **China-led AI ecosystem** could shift India's dependence from **US proprietary models to Chinese AI ecosystems** , whose data and training practices may lack transparency.
- **The 'Principles Gap':** India's digital architecture **emphasizes democratic values and human rights.**

- In contrast, China's AI regime mandates that models **align with state objectives**. A Beijing-led platform may struggle to **host the transparent and secure standards** that India's digital economy requires.
- **Impact on Domestic Innovation:** While open-source AI reduces access costs, an influx of free, highly capable foreign open-weight models could severely undermine the commercial viability of India's domestic model builders (like **Sarvam or BharatGen**), as enterprise buyers might opt for free Chinese releases.

What are the Impediments to India's AI sovereignty?

- **Capacity Surge vs. Cost:** India's data center capacity stands at **1.6 GW (mid-2026)** and is projected to nearly quadruple to **6 GW by 2029**. Scaling this AI infrastructure requires a massive **USD 110 billion investment**.
- **Resource Deficit:** Advanced AI GPUs require hyper-intensive cooling and power. Indian data centers currently consume roughly **150 billion liters of water** and **0.5% of national electricity** annually (CEEW, 2025) figures projected to more than double by 2030, heavily straining local grids and water tables.
- **Spatial Concentration (Latency):** Development is deeply skewed. **Mumbai alone accounts for up to 50%** of India's data center stock.
 - This extreme concentration creates severe latency bottlenecks for AI deployment in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.
- **Import Dependency:** Despite local manufacturing pushes, India still imports **90-95% of its semiconductors**, leaving its AI ambitions highly vulnerable to geopolitical shocks, particularly any conflict or blockade in the **Taiwan Strait**, a critical hub of global advanced semiconductor production.
- **The Missing Cutting-Edge: India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)** has successfully attracted over **USD 20 billion in investments**. However, these facilities focus on mature nodes (28nm to 110nm) and packaging.
 - India remains **100% reliant on foreign foundries** (like **TSMC**) for the advanced sub-5nm chips necessary to train foundational AI models.
- **Cross-Border Data Flows:** The **Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023** uses a "blacklist" (negative list) approach for international data transfers.
 - Unlike the EU's GDPR which offers clear adequacy assessments, this grants the government wide discretion, creating unpredictability that delays massive foreign cloud infrastructure investments.
- **Intellectual Property (IP) Ambiguity:** India's **Copyright Act, 1957** is ill-equipped for generative AI. Unresolved legal questions regarding the "fair use" of copyrighted material to train LLMs and the ownership of AI-generated outputs deter domestic startups from scaling indigenous models.

What Measures can Strengthen India's AI Sovereignty?

- **Accelerating the 'IndiaAI Mission':** Under **IndiaAI Mission**, India must fasttrack building **Sovereign AI** ecosystems (foundational models trained on diverse Indian datasets, reflecting Indian cultural and linguistic nuances (e.g., the Bhashini initiative).
- **Investing in Compute Infrastructure:** AI supremacy requires immense computational power. India

- must aggressively pursue public-private partnerships to build domestic GPU clusters and AI supercomputers, reducing reliance on foreign cloud infrastructure.
- **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) Approach to AI:** India should extend its successful **DPI model (like UPI)** to AI .
 - By offering secure, transparent, and indigenous open-source AI tools as a public good, India can present a democratic alternative to China's AI diplomacy for the developing world.
 - **Integrating into Global Tech Supply Chains:** India must leverage global partnerships to secure its hardware supply chains. This includes deepening the **US-India initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology (iCET)** and the **Quad Semiconductor Supply Chain Initiative**.
 - **Global AI Governance:** India should leverage platforms like the **G20 and the Global Partnership on Artificial Intelligence (GPAI)** to advocate for a multi-stakeholder governance framework. This framework must address technical risks like "agentic misalignment" while ensuring that AI regulation does not stifle the economic growth of the Global South.
 - **Grassroots Capacity Building :** True sovereignty requires a skilled demographic dividend. The **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020** must be realigned to focus strictly on computational thinking and AI ethics at the primary level.
 - The vast network of **Atal Tinkering Labs (ATLs)** should be upgraded into AI-tinkering hubs to shape young minds, ensuring the workforce is ready to build not just consume future AI technologies.

Conclusion

AI is emerging as a **key determinant of national sovereignty and global security** , amid rising **agentic risks and geopolitical competition** . India must balance AI adoption with **technological self-reliance** , by building **sovereign compute capacity** and promoting **transparent, democratic digital infrastructure** to ensure a safe and inclusive global AI ecosystem.

Drishti Mains Question:

China's proposed BRICS open-source AI community reflects the emergence of technology diplomacy as an instrument of geopolitical influence. Examine its implications for India's strategic autonomy.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is agentic misalignment?

It refers to situations where **autonomous AI agents pursue objectives that conflict with human intentions, ethical boundaries or operator interests** .

2. What is the IndiaAI Mission?

The **₹10,300 crore IndiaAI Mission** seeks to strengthen India's AI ecosystem through measures including **AI compute capacity, indigenous models, datasets, skills and innovation** .

3. Why is China promoting open-source AI?

China seeks to expand its **global technological influence** by making capable AI models and infrastructure accessible, particularly to **Global South countries** , while reducing dependence on Western AI ecosystems.

4. Why is sovereign AI important for India?

Sovereign AI can reduce dependence on foreign models, cloud infrastructure and computing resources while ensuring greater control over **data, privacy, security and culturally relevant AI systems** .

5. How can India strengthen its AI ecosystem?

India should expand **domestic compute infrastructure, indigenous foundation models, AI datasets, public-private partnerships and AI-focused governance** , while using **Digital Public Infrastructure** to promote accessible and accountable AI.

[Watch Video on YouTube:

▶ <https://www.youtube.com/embed/hfXyDIsRdCQ>

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UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims

Q. With the present state of development, Artificial Intelligence can effectively do which of the following? (2020)

1. Bring down electricity consumption in industrial units
2. Create meaningful short stories and songs
3. Disease diagnosis
4. Text-to-Speech Conversion
5. Wireless transmission of electrical energy

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 5 only
- (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 2, 4 and 5 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

Ans: (b)

Mains

Q. Introduce the concept of Artificial Intelligence (AI). How does AI help clinical diagnosis? Do you perceive any threat to privacy of the individual in the use of AI in healthcare? (2023)

India's Path to Blue Skies



Source: PIB

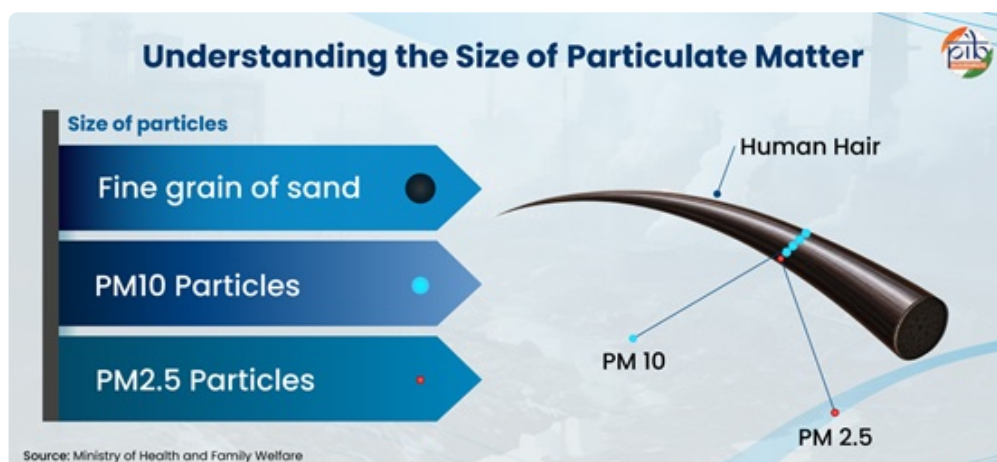
Why in News?

Recently, the **International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies (7 September)** was observed globally to raise awareness and promote action against air pollution. Designated by the **United Nations General Assembly in 2019**, the day highlights global efforts to improve air quality.

- India observes it as **Swachh Vayu Diwas**, aligning international commitments with national clean-air

What is Air Pollution?

- **About:** Air pollution refers to the accumulation of harmful substances in the atmosphere at levels that adversely affect **human health and the environment** . These pollutants may exist as **gases, liquid droplets or solid particles** and originate from both **natural processes and human activities** such as transport, industries, construction and burning.
- **Significance:** Clean air is fundamental to human health, environmental sustainability and economic well-being, making air pollution control a key global priority.
- **Particulate Matter (PM):** **Particulate Matter (PM)** is a major air pollutant consisting of tiny solid or liquid particles suspended in the atmosphere. It is classified mainly into:
 - **PM10:** Particles with a diameter of **10 micrometres or less** .
 - **PM2.5:** Fine particles with a diameter of **2.5 micrometres or less** , capable of penetrating deep into the respiratory system and, in some cases, entering the bloodstream.
- **Health Significance:** Due to their extremely small size, **PM2.5 particles pose greater health risks** by reaching deeper lung tissues and increasing the risk of respiratory and cardiovascular diseases, making particulate pollution control essential for **clean air and healthier communities** .



Air Pollution Monitoring Systems

System	Purpose and Features
Continuous Ambient Air Quality Monitoring System (CAAQMS)	Provides automated, real-time monitoring of pollutants such as PM_{2.5}, PM₁₀, SO₂, NO_x, CO, O₃ and NH₃ to support timely air-quality assessment.
Ambient Air Quality Monitoring System (AAQMS)	Includes both manual and automated monitoring systems . Manual monitoring involves 24-hour sampling and laboratory analysis, while automated systems continuously measure pollutants and meteorological parameters.
Online Continuous Emission Monitoring System (OCEMS)	Installed in highly polluting industries to continuously monitor emissions (and applicable discharges) and transmit data to regulatory authorities for compliance with prescribed environmental standards.

What are India's Initiatives to Mitigate Air Pollution?

National Air Quality Monitoring Programme (NAMP)

- **About:** The **National Ambient Air Quality Monitoring Programme (NAAQM)** , later renamed **NAMP** , was initiated by the **Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)** to assess ambient air quality, monitor pollution trends, identify violations of air quality standards and evaluate associated health risks.
- **Monitoring Network:** As of **March 2026** , India’s air-quality monitoring network consists of **1,646 stations across 603 cities in 28 States and 7 Union Territories** , including:
 - **Manual monitoring stations:** Collect air samples periodically for laboratory analysis.
 - **Continuous Ambient Air Quality Monitoring Stations (CAAQMS):** Provide real-time air quality data.
- **Citizen Access and Transparency:** The **SAMEER mobile application and web portal** provide near real-time **Air Quality Index (AQI)** information for more than **292 cities** , while grievance portals in **NCAP cities** promote public participation in pollution control.

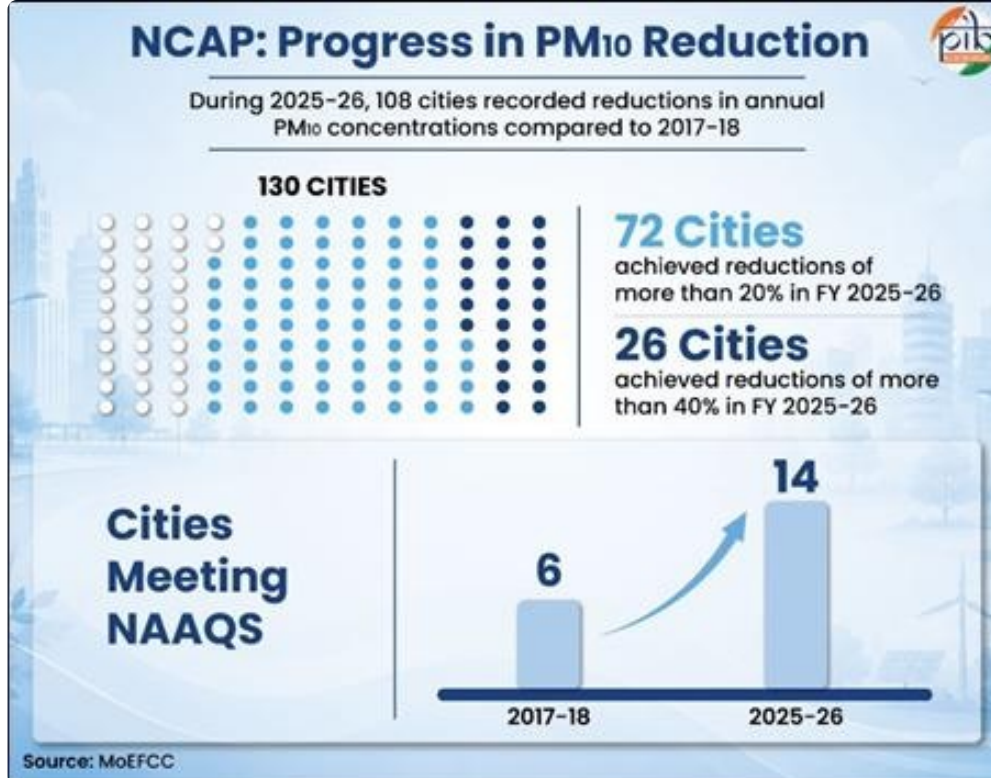
Air Quality Index (AQI)

- **About:** AQI is a public communication tool that simplifies air quality information by categorising pollution levels based on pollutant concentration and health impacts.
- **Pollutants Covered:** AQI is calculated using **eight pollutants** : PM_{2.5}, PM₁₀, Nitrogen Dioxide (NO₂), Sulphur Dioxide (SO₂), Carbon Monoxide (CO), Ozone (O₃), Ammonia (NH₃) and Lead (Pb).

AQI Category	AQI Range
Good	0-50
Satisfactory	51-100
Moderate	101-200
Poor	201-300
Very Poor	301-400
Severe	401-500

National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)

- **Launch:** The **National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)** was launched in **2019** to address urban air pollution through a mission-mode approach covering **130 cities** .
- **Approach:** NCAP promotes **source-specific pollution control measures** through city, state and national-level clean air action plans involving Central and State Governments, Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) and Other stakeholders.
- **Key Achievements of NCAP:**
 - **24 States/UTs and 130 cities** have prepared city-specific and state-specific action plans targeting major pollution sources.
 - During **FY 2019-20 to FY 2025-26** , **₹16,423.55 crore** was provided to 130 cities through air-quality performance-linked grants, of which **₹11,575.54 crore (70.5%)** has been utilised.
 - In **FY 2025-26** , **108 cities recorded a reduction in annual PM10 concentration** compared with 2017-18 levels



Digital Tracking of Air Quality Improvement

- **PRANA Portal (Portal for Regulation of Air-Pollution in Non-Attainment Cities):** Tracks the physical and financial progress of NCAP implementation. It provides information on city air action plans and pollution-control activities and supports evidence-based policymaking.

Swachh Vayu Survekshan

- **About:** Launched in **2022-23** by the **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**, **Swachh Vayu Survekshan** is an annual assessment of **130 NCAP cities** based on air pollution mitigation efforts.
- **Objective:** It promotes Healthy competition among cities, Innovation in pollution-control measures and Effective implementation of City-specific Clean Air Action Plans.
- **Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2026: Ward-level Swachh Vayu Survekshan** strengthens the bottom-up approach by recognising local actions for improving air quality. It was conducted across more than **7,400 wards nationwide**.
 - The **Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2026** recognised top-performing cities across three categories, with **Lucknow** securing first place in Category 1, **Rourkela** in Category 2, and **Kalinganagar** in Category 3.

What are the Sector-Wise Key Mitigation Measures Taken to Improve Air Quality?

Vehicular Emissions

- **Promotion of Cleaner Vehicles:** India introduced **BS-VI compliant vehicles** across the country from **April 2020** to significantly reduce vehicular emissions.
 - The government is promoting **electric mobility** through initiatives such as the **PM E-DRIVE scheme**

- of the Ministry of Heavy Industries and **PM E-Bus Sewa** of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.
- Expansion of **electric vehicle charging infrastructure** is being undertaken as per guidelines issued by the Ministry of Power.
- **Vehicle Fleet Modernisation:** The **Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)** has established an enabling framework for the **Vehicle Scrapping Policy** through **Registered Vehicle Scrapping Facilities (RVSFs)** and **Automated Testing Stations (ATS)** .
 - The **Pollution Under Control (PUC) certification system** is being strengthened to improve compliance and monitoring of vehicle emissions.
- **Reducing Urban Transport Pollution:** City-level clean air action plans include measures such as **traffic decongestion, junction improvement and improved public transport management** to reduce emissions from vehicular movement.
 - The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs launched **PARIVARTAN (Program for Accelerated Renewal and Incentivization of Vehicle Assets for Reducing Transport Air-Pollution and Network Emission)** to modernise transport fleets in NCR replacing **BS-IV and older trucks and buses** with BS-VI, CNG or EVs.
- **Delhi-NCR Specific Measures:** The **Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM)** has directed Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh to shift public transport, particularly buses, towards cleaner fuels. Only **BS-VI, CNG and electric buses** will be permitted to enter Delhi, including tourist buses, from **1 November 2026** .
 - CAQM has also directed faster adoption of cleaner mobility solutions by **motor vehicle aggregators, delivery service providers and e-commerce entities** .
 - Delhi and NCR districts are gradually introducing only **electric L5-category three-wheelers** for passenger and goods transport.

Industrial Emissions

- **Emission Standards and Industrial Classification:** The **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)** has notified sector-specific environmental standards for industries under the **Environment Protection Rules, 1986** .
 - The **Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)** has classified **419 industrial sectors and sub-sectors** according to their pollution potential.
- **Continuous Emission Monitoring:** The CPCB has mandated **17 highly polluting industrial sectors** to install **Online Continuous Emission Monitoring Systems (OCEMS)** connected with CPCB servers for real-time compliance monitoring.
 - In Delhi-NCR, industries are required to use approved fuels and install appropriate pollution-control equipment.
- **Strengthening Industrial Compliance:** CAQM has revised particulate matter emission standards for large and polluting industries, setting a limit of **50 mg/Nm³ from 1 October 2026** .
 - State Pollution Control Boards have been directed to ensure strict monitoring and enforcement in industrial areas violating prescribed norms.
 - The **CEPI (Comprehensive Environmental Pollution Index)** framework identifies **Critically Polluted Areas (CPAs)** and **Severely Polluted Areas (SPAs)** , where targeted pollution reduction plans are implemented.
- **Power Sector Emission Control:** In **2022** , MoEFCC notified stricter **CPCB IV+ emission standards** for power generators up to **800 kW** operating on diesel, gasoline or dual fuel modes.

Road Dust and Construction Pollution

- **Dust Management at Construction Sites:** CPCB has issued guidelines for environmentally sustainable management of **Construction and Demolition (C&D) waste** and for controlling dust generated from construction activities.
 - State Pollution Control Boards and Pollution Control Committees are required to deploy **anti-smog guns and dust-control measures** at construction sites exceeding **20,000 sq. metres** .
- **Institutional Monitoring Mechanism:** Road-owning and construction agencies in NCR have been directed to establish **Dust Control and Management Cells (DCMCs)** for monitoring dust-control measures.
 - Around **70 DCMCs** have been established across NCR and are regularly reviewed by CAQM.
 - An online monitoring mechanism has been introduced for construction sites above **500 sq. metres** in Delhi-NCR.

Open Waste Burning

- **Strengthening Waste Management:** The government is implementing various waste management regulations, including:
 - **Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016 (revised 2026)** .
 - **Plastic Waste Management Rules, 2016** .
 - **Hazardous Waste Management Rules, 2016** .
 - **E-Waste Management Rules, 2022** .
 - **Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022** .
 - **Biomedical Waste Management Rules, 2016** .
- **Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR):** Market-based **EPR mechanisms** require producers to manage post-consumer waste such as plastic packaging, e-waste, batteries, tyres and used oil.
 - This promotes recycling, reduces landfill burden and prevents emissions from informal waste burning.
- **Plastic Waste Reduction:** India banned **12 single-use plastic items** with low utility and high littering potential, including plastic cutlery, straws and thermocol decorations, from **1st July 2022** .

Crop Residue and Biomass Burning

- **Promoting Alternative Uses of Crop Residue:** Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) provides financial assistance for establishing **paddy straw pelletisation and torrefaction plants** to promote productive utilisation of agricultural waste.
 - Under this initiative, **₹37.16 crore** has been sanctioned for **34 plants** , including **27 in Punjab and 7 in Haryana** .
- **Biomass Utilisation in Energy Sector:** CAQM has directed **5-10% biomass co-firing** in thermal power plants within 300 km of Delhi, as well as captive power plants and brick kilns in NCR, to reduce open burning of crop residue.
- **Support to Farmers:** The Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare provided **₹4,233.84 crore (2018-19 to 2025-26)** for crop residue management.
 - More than **3.53 lakh crop residue management machines** have been distributed, and **43,535 Custom Hiring Centres (CHCs)** have been established in Punjab, Haryana, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Delhi.
- **Impact:** Due to coordinated efforts, paddy stubble-burning incidents declined by **93% in Punjab** and

91% in Haryana in 2025 compared with 2021 .

Afforestation and Expansion of Green Cover

- **Green India Mission:** The mission focuses on improving forest quality, enhancing ecological resilience and increasing carbon sequestration. **₹1,019.26 crore** has been released to States under the mission till **March 2026** .
- **Compensatory Afforestation:** The **Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority (CAMPA)** supports forest restoration and ecological conservation.
 - More than **3.20 lakh hectares** of compensatory afforestation were undertaken during **FY 2020-21 to FY 2024-25** .
- **Urban Green Spaces:** The **Nagar Van Yojana (launched in 2020)** aims to develop **1,000 Nagar Vans and Vatikas by 2026-27** . As of **31st March 2026** , ₹557.62 crore has been released for developing **626 Nagar Vans/Vatikas** .
- **Landscape Restoration Initiatives:** The **Aravalli Green Wall Initiative** targets restoration of **6.31 million hectares** across Rajasthan, Gujarat, Haryana and Delhi. It has established **435 nurseries** with a capacity of **393.24 lakh seedlings** and restored around **36,025 hectares during 2025** .
- **Community Participation:** The **Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam campaign** has emerged as a mass plantation movement, with **262.4 crore saplings planted by December 2025** .

What are the Institutions Driving India's Clean Air Goals?

Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)

- The **Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)** is a statutory organisation established under the **Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974** and performs functions related to air pollution control under the **Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981** .
- CPCB is responsible for improving air quality by undertaking **ambient air quality monitoring, formulation of pollution control standards, technical assessment and coordination with State Pollution Control Boards** .

Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM)

- The **Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM)** was established under the **Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas Act, 2021** as a dedicated statutory institution for managing air pollution in the **Delhi-NCR airshed** .
- CAQM ensures coordinated action among Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh to address regional sources of pollution that cannot be managed through isolated State-level measures.

Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP)

- The **Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP)** is an emergency response framework designed to address worsening air quality conditions in Delhi-NCR through **time-bound and progressively stricter measures** .
- GRAP is activated based on the **Air Quality Index (AQI)**, **weather conditions and scientific assessments** to ensure timely action during periods of severe pollution.
- The plan consists of four stages:
 - **Stage I - Poor Air Quality (AQI 201-300)**
 - **Stage II - Very Poor Air Quality (AQI 301-400)**
 - **Stage III - Severe Air Quality (AQI 401-450)**
 - **Stage IV - Severe+ Air Quality (AQI above 450)**

State Pollution Control Boards (SPCBs)

- **State Pollution Control Boards (SPCBs)** are the primary regulatory institutions responsible for implementing environmental laws at the State level.
- SPCBs regulate pollution from industries by:
 - Monitoring industrial emissions.
 - Granting environmental consents.
 - Ensuring compliance with prescribed emission standards.
 - Taking enforcement action against violating industries.
- Their responsibilities have expanded beyond the **Water Act, Air Act and Environment Protection Act** to include monitoring of **noise pollution, hazardous waste, plastic waste and other environmental concerns** .

Strengthening Environmental Regulation through Digital Reforms

- To improve transparency, consistency and efficiency in environmental regulation, the Government amended the **Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981** and the **Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974** .
- The Government notified:
 - **Control of Air Pollution (Grant, Refusal or Cancellation of Consent) Guidelines, 2025** on **29th January 2025** .
 - **Water Pollution (Grant, Refusal or Cancellation of Consent) Guidelines, 2025** on **30th January 2025** .
- The **Unified Consent and Authorization Management System (UCAMS)** developed by CPCB provides an online platform for processing consent applications by SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees.
- UCAMS enables **end-to-end digital processing of consent approval, refusal and cancellation** , ensuring greater **uniformity in procedures, transparency in decision-making and better compliance monitoring** .

Conclusion

India's journey towards **blue skies** requires sustained, science-based and collaborative action. Through programmes such as **NCAP**, strengthened monitoring systems, cleaner technologies and ecosystem restoration, India is moving towards healthier air and sustainable development. Continued cooperation among governments, industries and citizens will be crucial to achieving long-term air-quality improvement and building environmentally resilient communities.

Drishti Mains Practice Questions

"Air pollution in India is not merely an environmental issue but a multidimensional challenge affecting public health, economy and sustainable development." Discuss.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1. What is the International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies?

Observed on **7 September** every year and designated by the **United Nations General Assembly in 2019** to promote global awareness and action against air pollution; India observes it as **Swachh Vayu Diwas**.

Q2. What is the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)?

Launched in **2019**, NCAP is a mission-mode programme covering **130 cities** that aims to reduce air pollution through **city-specific clean air action plans, source-based interventions, improved monitoring and institutional coordination**.

Q3. What is the difference between PM2.5 and PM10?

PM10 consists of particles with a diameter of **10 micrometres or less**, while **PM2.5** consists of finer particles of **2.5 micrometres or less** that can penetrate deep into lungs and even enter the bloodstream, posing greater health risks.

Q4. What is AQI?

Air Quality Index (AQI) is a public communication tool that categorises air quality based on concentrations of **eight pollutants — PM2.5, PM10, NO₂, SO₂, CO, O₃, NH₃ and Lead (Pb)** and their associated health impacts.

Q5. What is the PRANA Portal?

PRANA (Portal for Regulation of Air-Pollution in Non-Attainment Cities) is a digital platform that tracks the **physical and financial progress of NCAP implementation** and provides information on air-quality management activities.

[Watch Video on YouTube: [▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/VZWArzmaQc](https://www.youtube.com/embed/VZWArzmaQc)]

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims

Q. Artificial way of causing rainfall to reduce air pollution makes use of (2025)

- a) silver iodide and potassium iodide
- b) silver nitrate and potassium iodide
- c) silver iodide and potassium nitrate
- d) silver nitrate and potassium chloride

Ans: (a)

Q. How is the National Green Tribunal (NGT) different from the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)? (2018)

1. The NGT has been established by an Act whereas the CPCB has been created by an executive order of the Government.
2. The NGT provides environmental justice and helps reduce the burden of litigation in the higher courts whereas the CPCB promotes cleanliness of streams and wells, and aims to improve the quality of air in the country.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans: (b)

Mains

Q. Describe the key points of the revised Global Air Quality Guidelines (AQGs) recently released by the World Health Organisation (WHO). How are these different from its last update in 2005? What changes in India's National Clean Air Programme are required to achieve revised standards? (2021)

9th Rashtriya Poshan Maah 2026



Source: PIB

Why in News?

The **9th Rashtriya Poshan Maah (National Nutrition Month) 2026** was launched, highlighting the **importance of Anganwadi Centres** and **promoting balanced, protein-rich nutrition among pregnant and lactating women**.

What are the Key Focus Areas of Rashtriya Poshan Maah 2026?

- **About:** Launched on **9th September 2026** at **Rudraksh International Cooperation and Convention Centre, Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh)**, it highlights the role of **Anganwadi Centres** as the **world's largest childcare network** providing nutrition, care and early childhood development services.
- **Theme: "Hamari Anganwadi, Hamari Jimmedari"**, highlighting **collective ownership and community responsibility** for strengthening Anganwadi Centres.
- **Promoting Dietary Diversity and Better Nutrition:** The campaign emphasises improving dietary diversity by encouraging **adequate protein intake, consumption of diverse food groups and greater use of locally available nutritious foods** to address nutritional deficiencies.
- **Improving Quality of Supplementary Nutrition Programme (SNP):** It focuses on providing **fresh and diverse Hot Cooked Meals (HCM)** through better menu rotation, improved hygiene practices and quality assurance mechanisms at Anganwadi Centres.
- **Strengthening Community Ownership of Anganwadi Centres:** The initiative aims to enhance accountability and participation through **Anganwadi Monitoring Committees (AMCs)**, along with the display of **Supplementary Nutrition Programme Menu Boards** for greater transparency.
- **Linking Nutrition with Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE):** The campaign highlights that **nutrition and cognitive development are interconnected**, with adequate nutrition serving as a foundation for early learning, brain development and overall childhood growth.
- **Focusing on Maternal Nutrition and the First 1,000 Days:** Rashtriya Poshan Maah 2026 will commemorate **10 years of Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana (PMMVY)**, India's flagship maternity benefit programme.
 - It highlights the role of maternal nutrition, healthcare-seeking behaviour and income support during pregnancy in ensuring healthy growth and lifelong well-being of children.



What are the Key Facts About Rashtriya Poshan Maah?

- **Launch of POSHAN Abhiyaan (2018):** The Government of India launched **POSHAN Abhiyaan** in **March 2018** as a **multi-ministerial convergence mission** to place nutrition at the centre of the development agenda.
- **Mission Poshan 2.0 (2021-22):** Nutrition-related interventions were integrated under **Mission Poshan 2.0**, India's **unified National Nutrition Mission** implemented by the **Ministry of Women and Child Development**.
- **Components of Mission Poshan 2.0:**
 - **POSHAN Abhiyaan:** Focuses on **technology-driven monitoring, Jan Andolan (mass mobilisation)** and behavioural change for improving nutrition outcomes.
 - **Anganwadi Services/ICDS:** Provides **supplementary nutrition, hot cooked meals and early childhood care services**.
 - **Scheme for Adolescent Girls:** Provides nutritional support to **out-of-school adolescent girls**.
 - **Rashtriya Poshan Maah**: Observed every **September**, it serves as a platform to create awareness about **Mission Poshan 2.0** and encourage community participation in improving nutrition outcomes.
- **Malnutrition Challenge:** **Malnutrition** remains a major public health challenge in India, affecting the **health, growth, learning outcomes and productivity** of women and children across the life cycle.



POSHAN Abhiyaan as a People's Movement

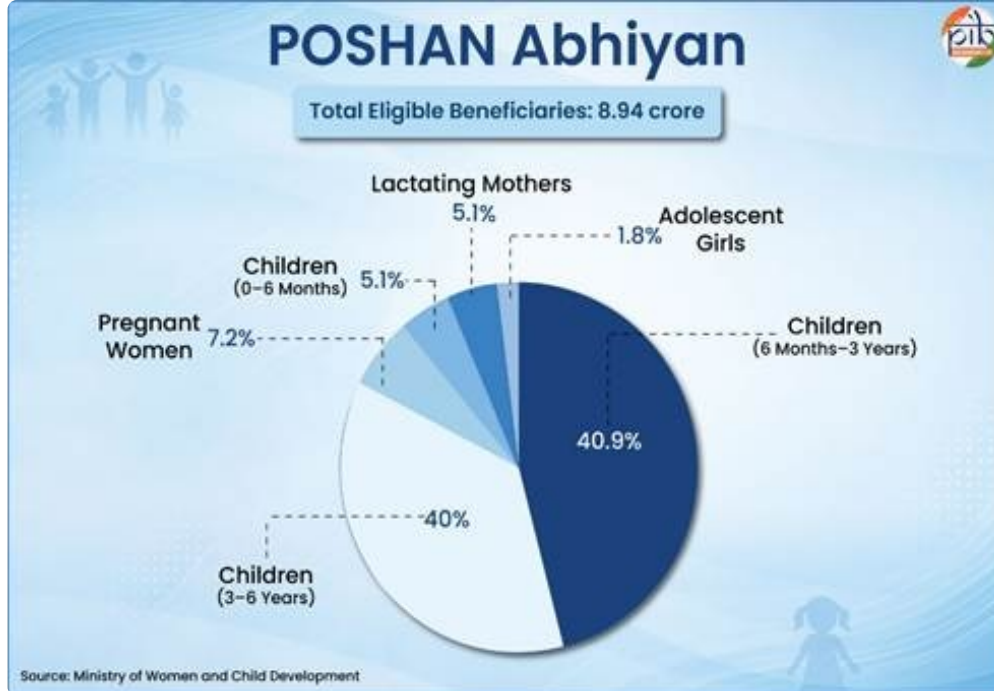
- POSHAN Abhiyaan adopts a **Jan Andolan (people's movement)** approach by positioning nutrition improvement as a shared societal responsibility rather than merely a government programme.
- It recognises that sustainable behavioural changes related to **infant feeding practices, dietary diversity, antenatal care, hand hygiene and institutional healthcare seeking** can only be achieved through active community participation and ownership.

Poshan Pakhwada 2026

- **About:** Poshan Pakhwada has been observed annually since **2018** as a **two-week intensive outreach campaign conducted in April** . It aims to strengthen community mobilisation and reinforce key nutrition-related behaviours under **POSHAN Abhiyaan** .
- **8th Poshan Pakhwada (2026):** The **8th Poshan Pakhwada** was conducted from **9th April to 23rd April 2026** with the central theme **“Maximizing Brain Development in the First Six Years of Life.”**
- **Focus on Early Childhood Development:** The campaign highlighted that **more than 85% of brain development occurs by the age of six years** , with the most rapid development taking place during the **first 1,000 days of life** .
- **Promoting a Holistic Nutrition Approach:** Poshan Pakhwada 2026 aimed to expand the understanding of nutrition beyond disease prevention by promoting the idea of **“nutrition and early childhood stimulation for optimal brain development.”**
- **Significance:** Poshan Maah and **Poshan Pakhwada** **nutrition-focused community mobilisation campaigns** promote awareness and behavioural change regarding **health, wellness, immunity and improved nutrition outcomes** among communities.

Poshan Tracker

- **Launch and Objective:** The **Poshan Tracker** was launched on **1st March 2021** as a digital governance platform for monitoring the implementation of **Anganwadi Services** and improving transparency in nutrition service delivery.
- **Real-Time Monitoring of Nutrition Services:** The platform enables near real-time monitoring of key indicators, including:
 - Functioning and opening of **Anganwadi Centres**
 - Daily attendance of children
 - **Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE)** activities
 - Growth monitoring of beneficiaries
- **Beneficiary Coverage:** The Poshan Tracker monitors nutrition services for **Pregnant women** , **Lactating mothers** , **Children up to six years of age** and **Adolescent girls**.



Conclusion

The **Rashtriya Poshan Maah** represents India's shift from a welfare-based approach to a **community-driven nutrition mission**. Through **Mission Poshan 2.0, Anganwadi strengthening, digital monitoring and behavioural change initiatives**, India aims to build healthier families and a nutritionally secure nation.

Drishti Mains Practice Questions

Rashtriya Poshan Maah represents a shift from a government-led nutrition programme to a community-driven Jan Andolan. Examine its significance in improving nutrition outcomes.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is Rashtriya Poshan Maah?

Rashtriya Poshan Maah (National Nutrition Month) is observed every **September** to create awareness, promote behavioural change and strengthen community participation for improving nutrition outcomes.

2. When was POSHAN Abhiyaan launched?

POSHAN Abhiyaan was launched in March 2018 as a multi-ministerial convergence mission to address malnutrition through technology, community mobilisation and behavioural change.

3. What is Mission Poshan 2.0?

Mission Poshan 2.0 is India's **unified National Nutrition Mission** launched in **Union Budget 2021-22**, integrating POSHAN Abhiyaan, Anganwadi Services/ICDS and Scheme for Adolescent Girls.

4. Which ministry implements Mission Poshan 2.0?

Mission Poshan 2.0 is implemented under the **Ministry of Women and Child Development (MoWCD)**.

5. What is the theme of 9th Rashtriya Poshan Maah 2026?

The theme is **"Hamari Anganwadi, Hamari Jimmedari"**, focusing on strengthening Anganwadi Centres through community ownership and accountability.

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims:

Q. Which of the following is/are the indicators/ indicators used by IFPRI to compute the Global Hunger Index Report? (2016)

1. Undernourishment
2. Child stunting
3. Child mortality

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) 1 and 3 only

Ans: C

Mains:

Q. How far do you agree with the view that the focus on lack of availability of food as the main cause of hunger takes the attention away from ineffective human development policies in India? **(2018)**

U.K. Recognises India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme



Source: TH

Why in News?

The **United Kingdom** has recognised India's **Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS)** as a qualifying carbon pricing mechanism under its **Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM)** , allowing Indian exporters to receive carbon price relief.

- The move follows technical engagement between India and the U.K. and will continue through frameworks such as the **U.K.-India Energy Memorandum of Understanding** and the **Partnership for Market Implementation** .

What is the Significance of U.K.'s Recognition of India's CCTS?

- **Impact on Indian Exporters:** U.K. importers of eligible Indian goods covered under CBAM can claim relief corresponding to the **effective carbon price already paid under India's CCTS** , reducing the additional CBAM liability on Indian exports.
- **Avoiding Double Carbon Pricing:** The recognition aligns with the principle of preventing **double taxation of emissions** , as products that have already borne an eligible carbon price in the country of origin receive corresponding adjustment under CBAM.
- **Significance:** The recognition strengthens India's participation in global carbon markets, supports export competitiveness, and provides greater certainty to carbon-intensive industries.
- **Limitation:** The actual CBAM relief will depend on the **effective carbon price paid by the exporter** and compliance with the **evidence and verification requirements** prescribed under U.K. CBAM rules.

What are the Key Facts About Carbon Credit Trading Scheme?

- **About:** The **Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS)** is a market-based mechanism under the **Indian Carbon Market (ICM)** that aims to reduce, remove, or avoid **greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions** by pricing emissions through the trading of **Carbon Credit Certificates (CCCs)** .
- **Transition from PAT to CCTS:** The earlier **Perform, Achieve and Trade (PAT) scheme** focused on improving **energy efficiency** through **Energy Saving Certificates (ESCs)** . CCTS shifts the focus towards reducing **Greenhouse Gas Emission Intensity (GEI)** by setting sector-specific emission intensity targets.
- **Mechanisms:**
 - **Compliance Mechanism:** Requires obligated energy-intensive industries to meet notified GEI targets. Entities exceeding targets receive CCCs, while others can purchase credits to meet obligations.
 - **Offset Mechanism:** Allows non-obligated entities to voluntarily register approved emission reduction activities for issuance of CCCs.
- **Sectors Covered:** CCTS initially covers major emission-intensive sectors such as **aluminium, cement, chlor-alkali, pulp and paper, iron and steel, fertilizer, petroleum refineries, petrochemicals, and textiles** .
 - Although the **thermal power sector contributes a significant share of India's emissions** , thermal power plants **have not yet been transitioned into the CCTS compliance mechanism** .
- **Regulatory Oversight:** The scheme is administered through the **Bureau of Energy Efficiency** (Administrator), **National Steering Committee for Indian Carbon Market, Grid Controller of India Limited (Registry)**, and regulatory support from CERC.
- **Significance:** CCTS supports India's climate objectives by encouraging clean technologies, energy efficiency, low-carbon technologies, **renewable energy adoption, and emission reduction measures**.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is the Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS)?

CCTS is a **market-based mechanism** introduced under the **Indian Carbon Market (ICM)** to reduce greenhouse gas emissions through carbon pricing and trading of carbon credits.

2. Under which framework was CCTS introduced?

CCTS was introduced under the **Energy Conservation Act, 2001 (amended in 2022)** to establish India's carbon market framework.

3. Why is the U.K.'s recognition of India's CCTS important?

It allows Indian exporters covered under the **U.K. Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM)** to receive carbon price relief. It helps avoid **double carbon pricing** on Indian goods.

4. How will U.K. recognition benefit Indian exporters?

Exporters can claim relief corresponding to the **effective carbon price already paid under CCTS**. It will reduce the additional **CBAM liability** on eligible Indian exports.

5. What is Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM)?

CBAM is a climate trade mechanism that imposes carbon costs on imported goods based on their embedded greenhouse gas emissions.

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims

Q. Consider the following statements (2023)

Statement—I: Carbon markets are likely to be one of the most widespread tools in the fight against climate change.

Statement—II: Carbon markets transfer resources from the private sector to the State.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement—I and Statement—II are correct and Statement—II is the correct explanation for Statement—I
- (b) Both Statement—I and Statement—II are correct and Statement—II is not the correct explanation for Statement—I
- (c) Statement—I is correct but Statement—II is incorrect
- (d) Statement—I is incorrect but Statement—II is correct

Ans: B

Q. The concept of carbon credit originated from which one of the following? (2009)

- (a) Earth Summit, Rio de Janeiro
- (b) Kyoto Protocol
- (c) Montreal Protocol
- (d) G-8 Summit, Heiligendamm

Ans: B

1st-Ever District-Level Estimates for the Unincorporated Non-Agricultural Sector



Source:PIB

The **National Statistical Office (NSO)** under the **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** released the **1 st -ever district-level estimates for India's unincorporated non-agricultural sector**, based on data from the **Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) 2025** .

- **Significance for Governance:** High-frequency, district-level data is essential for addressing regional economic imbalances and crafting targeted interventions for MSME formalization, micro-credit access, and women's economic empowerment under India's federal planning architecture.

Key Highlights of the District-Level Estimates

- **Unprecedented Granularity:** The **first District-Level Estimates** are available for **757 of 770 districts** , providing granular data to strengthen **sub-state statistics** and support **evidence-based, localised policymaking** .
- **Geographical Concentration:** The top 10 districts (located across Gujarat, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh, and West Bengal) generate about **10% of the country's unincorporated establishments**, workers, and **Gross Value Added (GVA)**.
 - The top 50 districts account for **nearly one-third of the sector's total establishments and workforce**.
 - Only 16 districts have over 5 lakh establishments, with half of them (8) located in West Bengal.
- **Productivity Disparities (GVA per Worker):** Gross Value Added (GVA) per worker acts as a proxy for economic productivity.
 - The all-India average **GVA per worker stands at Rs 1,56,539**. In 280 districts, productivity exceeds the national average, while 331 districts fall slightly below it (between Rs 1 lakh and Rs 1.5 lakh).
- **Women's Participation & Entrepreneurship:** In 237 districts, women constitute at least one-third of the total unincorporated workforce. In 25 districts, they make up more than 50% of the workforce.
 - The states with the highest share of female-led unincorporated establishments are **Telangana, Manipur, Meghalaya, and Mizoram**.
 - In Mizoram, female-owned proprietary establishments account for at least 50% in every single district.

Read more: [Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises \(ASUSE\) 2026](#)

Deferment of the Manipur Census



Source: TH

The Centre has indefinitely deferred the **decennial Census** operations in poll-bound Manipur to prevent the escalation of ongoing **ethnic tensions**, amidst mounting demands from civil society organizations to first implement a **State-specific National Register of Citizens (NRC)**.

- **The Core Dispute:** The scheduled **decennial Census** , which will serve as the basis for the upcoming **delimitation of constituencies** , faces strong opposition from **Meitei, Naga, and Meitei Pangal** groups.
 - They demand that an **NRC with 1951 as the base year** be prepared first to identify and deport **"illegal migrants"**.
- **Kuki-Zo Community:** The **Kuki-Zo Council** opposed the demand for postponement and the push for an **NRC** , calling a **1951-based NRC premature and unjustified** . It instead called for an **impartial Census** to provide accurate demographic data and counter the **illegal migrant** narrative.
 - They view a 1951-based NRC as biased and premature.
- **Demographic and Political Anxieties:** Pro-NRC groups argue that illegal migration from **Myanmar, Bangladesh, and Mizoram** has caused a massive population spike in the hill districts (allegedly a 2,165% growth since 1881).
 - There are fears that conducting a Census now could permanently skew **Legislative Assembly representation** in favor of migrants.
- **Link to the Myanmar Crisis:** The demand for an NRC gained immediate urgency following the **February 2021 military coup in Myanmar** .
 - The subsequent influx of **Kuki-Chin refugees** across porous borders severely exacerbated ethnic insecurities, leading the State Assembly to pass resolutions for a **State Population Commission** .
- **Complexities of the NRC Process:** Executing an error-free NRC is highly challenging.
 - For example, the **Supreme Court-monitored Assam NRC (2019)** excluded 19.06 lakh applicants but remains legally stalled and incomplete, as the **Registrar General of India** is yet to officially notify it as final.
- **Historical Precedents of Deferment:** A regional Census has been deferred twice in Indian history: in **Assam (1981)** due to the mass movement against undocumented immigration (which concluded with the **Assam Accord of 1985**) , and in **Jammu and Kashmir (1991)** due to the rise of violent extremism and the mass exodus of Kashmiri Pandits.
- **Legal Basis for Census Deferment:** Section 3, **Census Act, 1948** gives the Central Government discretion to conduct a Census whenever it considers it necessary or desirable.
 - The Census Act, 1948 and Census Rules, 1990 **do not mandate a strict 10-year periodicity**.

Read more: [Manipur Ethnic Conflict and UAPA Power Expansion](#)

Dhiraj Bommadevara: 1st Indian Man to Win Archery World Cup Final



Source: IE

Recently, Indian recurve archer **Dhiraj Bommadevara** became the first Indian male recurve archer to win the men's individual recurve title at the **Archery World Cup Final 2026** held in Saltillo, Mexico, defeating Japan's Junya Nakanishi in the final.

- He is the second Indian archer overall to win an individual Archery World Cup Final title , after **Dola Banerjee** , who won the women's recurve title in **2007 at Dubai** .
- According to **World Archery** , Bommadevara is ranked **World No. 4 in Recurve Men (RM)** , with his highest ranking also being **No. 4 achieved in September 2026** .
- **World Archery:** The **Archery World Cup Final** is organised by **World Archery** , the international governing body for the sport, and serves as the season-ending event featuring the top-performing archers from the World Cup circuit.
 - The **Hyundai Archery World Cup was introduced in 2006** as an annual international circuit, with archers competing across multiple stages to qualify for the final event.



Read More: [Sheetal Devi Named World Archery's Para Archer of the Year 2025](#)